

Hello everyone!

In this walkthrough, we'll solve the Explosion CTF room on HackTheBox by performing enumeration.



Description

Graphical User Interface (GUI)–based remote access tools, such as Windows Remote Desktop Protocol (RDP), allow users to interact with a remote system through a graphical desktop environment. While these technologies are relatively old, they have continuously evolved to improve usability and accessibility. From an attacker's perspective, misconfigured RDP services can be exploited to gain unauthorized access to a target system. Unlike CLI-based tools such as Telnet or SSH, RDP provides full desktop access, making it a high-value target. Weak credentials, default accounts, disabled security controls, or improper certificate validation can allow attackers to establish a remote session and fully compromise the system

Tools

- Nmap
- Xfreerdp

Analysis

Step 1: - In this step, verify whether the target is reachable using the **ping** command, then perform **port scanning** and **service/version detection** using **Nmap**.

```
ping -c 4 10.129.1.13
```

```
sudo nmap -sC -sV 10.129.1.13
```

```

(hacker@kali)~[/Desktop/HTB/Explosion]
$ ping -c 4 10.129.1.13
PING 10.129.1.13 (10.129.1.13) 56(84) bytes of data.
64 bytes from 10.129.1.13: icmp_seq=1 ttl=127 time=278 ms
64 bytes from 10.129.1.13: icmp_seq=2 ttl=127 time=267 ms
64 bytes from 10.129.1.13: icmp_seq=3 ttl=127 time=242 ms
64 bytes from 10.129.1.13: icmp_seq=4 ttl=127 time=244 ms

--- 10.129.1.13 ping statistics ---
4 packets transmitted, 4 received, 0% packet loss, time 3006ms
rtt min/avg/max/mdev = 242.285/257.645/277.604/14.964 ms

(hacker@kali)~[/Desktop/HTB/Explosion]
$ sudo nmap -sV 10.129.1.13
Starting Nmap 7.95 ( https://nmap.org ) at 2026-01-08 04:44 IST
Nmap scan report for 10.129.1.13
Host is up (0.28s latency).
Not shown: 995 closed tcp ports (reset)
PORT      STATE SERVICE        VERSION
135/tcp    open  msrpc          Microsoft Windows RPC
139/tcp    open  netbios-ssn    Microsoft Windows netbios-ssn
445/tcp    open  microsoft-ds?
3389/tcp   open  ms-wbt-server  Microsoft Terminal Services
5985/tcp   open  http           Microsoft HTTPAPI httpd 2.0 (SSDP/UPnP)
Service Info: OS: Windows; CPE: cpe:/o:microsoft:windows

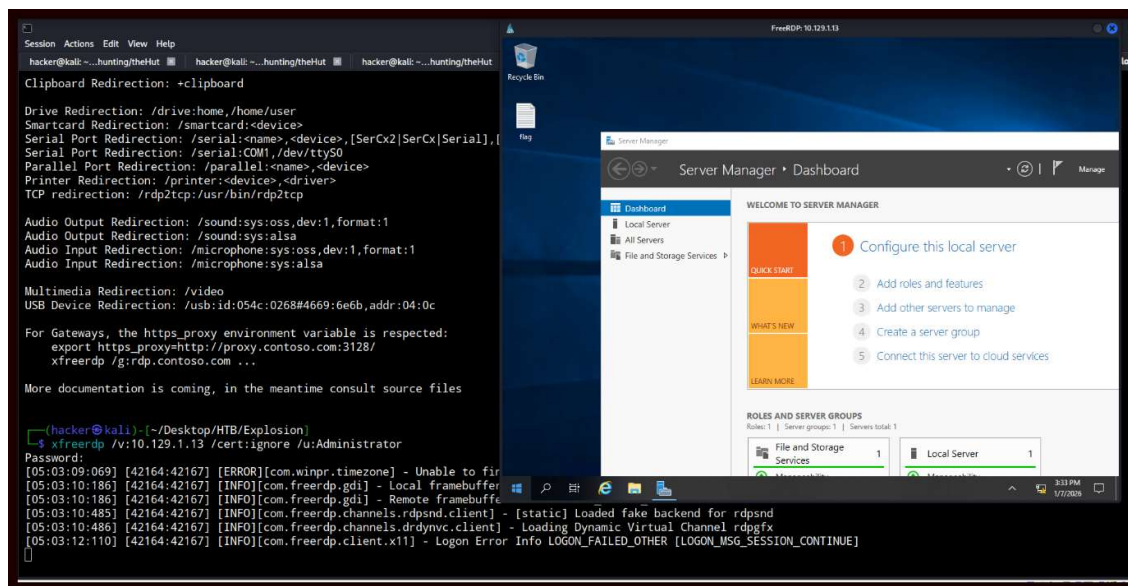
Service detection performed. Please report any incorrect results at https://nmap.org/submit/ .
Nmap done: 1 IP address (1 host up) scanned in 177.47 seconds

```

then show the some ports are open in this target but I am exploit this port like:- 3389

Step:- 3 In this step Attempt RDP login using a default account. Since the *Administrator* account has no password configured, we can connect without credentials by ignoring certificate checks

xfreerdp /v:10.129.1.13 /cert:ignore /u:Administrator



Thanks for Visiting

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